Team Rules for OpenAI Codex with AGENTS.md



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Overview



Same review comments, every PR

```
+ def apply_coupon(total, code):
+     if code not in COUPONS:
+         raise ValueError("bad coupon")
```

Reviewer: "We use AppError codes. Where are the tests?
And please update CHANGELOG.md." (again)

Write rules once → **Codex reads them** → **Fewer repeat fixes**

WHAT'S IN IT FOR YOU
Codex PRs that already follow your team's rules, and no more repeat review comments.

Rules Codex can follow, and you can check

Weak rule	Checkable rule
"Handle errors properly"	**Raise AppError with an UPPER_SNAKE code**
"Document your code"	**Docstring with an Example: line**
"Test your changes"	**Run: python -m unittest discover -s tests -v**
"Keep docs updated"	**A CHANGELOG.md line under Unreleased**

Test: could a reviewer check it in the diff?

AGENTS.md is an onboarding note

NEW TEAMMATE

Reads the team notes on day one…

…and forgets half by Friday.

CODEX

Reads AGENTS.md when every task starts…

…and never forgets.

Put it at the repo root, in Git

Edited it? Start a new thread

Write it for a smart new hire who has never seen your repo.

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Maliha's AGENTS.md

```
# Bookshop team rules
- Money is Decimal, never float
- Invalid input: raise AppError
  with an UPPER_SNAKE code
- Docstring with an Example: line
- Tests in tests/test_<module>.py
- Run: python -m unittest
    discover -s tests -v
- One line in CHANGELOG.md
- No new dependencies
```

CODE
how we write it

TESTS
how we prove it

HOUSEKEEPING
what else changes

Concrete, checkable rules. "Write clean code" does nothing.

Demo



What we'll do in Maliha's repo

1. **WITHOUT RULES**
   Ask Codex to add apply_coupon
2. **SPOT THE GAPS**
   Review the diff against team rules
3. **ADD AGENTS.md**
   Copy the rules file to the repo root
4. **SAME TASK AGAIN**
   Reset, new thread, same prompt
5. **COMPARE**
   AppError, tests, changelog in the diff

Your first AGENTS.md

What do you correct in every code review?

Those are your first three rules.



Commit it, so every teammate and every thread gets it.

Summary



Write team rules once, in the repo

Checkable rules change the diff

Codex rereads them every task

Rules guide Codex. Review still checks